

Our topic today is the believer in immaterial souls view that
we are (either wholly or in part) immaterial things.

You may recall that we came up with two believer in
immaterial souls answers to the identity question:

A large blue circle with a white drop shadow, containing the text "Simple dualism: I am an immaterial soul" in white. The text is centered and arranged in four lines.

**Simple
dualism: I am
an immaterial
soul**

A solid blue circle with a slight drop shadow, containing white text. The text is centered and reads: "Fusion dualism: I am a combination of a soul and a body".

Fusion
dualism: I am
a combination
of a soul
and a body

**Soul
survival:**

X is me just in
case X is the
same immaterial
soul as me

Fusion survival:

X is me just in case X
has the same immaterial
soul as me and is the
same material thing as
me

For right now we're going to set aside the question of which of these views is better.

Instead, we're going to ask a more fundamental question: is there any good reason to believe in the existence of immaterial souls?

Most of us don't believe in fairies, there being no good evidence for their existence. Why should souls be any different?

We're going to look at two different arguments for the
existence of souls.

Properties related to conscious experience include the property of feeling an itch or a pain, or the sensation of seeing red or hearing a loud noise. These properties are sometimes called **phenomenal properties**.

Human beings (obviously) have phenomenal properties — we
experience all kinds of sensations.

The argument we are going to look at turns on the idea that immaterial souls are needed to explain the nature of **consciousness**.

Suppose that we were wholly physical things (as both the organism view and the brain view say). What would that imply about the nature of our phenomenal properties?

The following principles seem plausible:

Wholly physical things have only
physical properties.

Our topic today is the believer in materialism's view that

we are (either wholly or in part) immaterial things.

You may recall that we came up with two believers in

in materialism answers to the identity question:

For right now we're going to set aside the question of which

of these views is better.

Instead, we're going to ask a more fundamental question: is

there any good reason to believe in the existence of

in materials?

different?

evidence for their existence. Why should souls be any

Most of us don't believe in fairies, there being no good

existence of souls.

We're going to look at two different arguments for the

Properties related to conscious experience include the

property of feeling an itch or a pain, or the sensation of

sometimes called phenomenal properties.

seeing red or hearing a loud noise. These properties are

Human beings (obviously) have phenomenal properties — we

experience all kinds of sensations.

the idea that in materialist studies are needed to

The argument we are going to look at turns on

explain the nature of consciousness.

are needed to explain the nature of

turns on the idea that in materials

We're going to look at two. The first

consciousness.

organism view and the brain view say). What would that imply

Suppose that we were wholly physical things (as both the

about the nature of our phenomenal properties?



Wholly physical things have only
physical properties.